

Mixed Mini-Check: All Six Skills

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Not timed. Answer in your book, in full sentences. 12 marks. The marks tell you how much to write.

The text: Closing Time

Mr Adeyemi turned the sign to CLOSED an hour early, though the shop had never once shut before six in forty years. He wiped the counter that was already clean, then wiped it again. Outside, the rain drummed its impatient fingers on the awning.

The letter from the council lay on the till where he had left it that morning, still unopened. He knew what it said. The new supermarket had opened in March—three floors, free parking, bread at half his price—and by August his regulars had become occasional, then rare.

He took down the photograph beside the door: his father in a white apron, standing outside this same shop in 1961, squinting into the sun. Mr Adeyemi looked at it for a long time. Then he wrapped it in newspaper, as carefully as if it were something breakable, and put it in the box at his feet.

He did not switch the lights off straight away. He stood in the empty aisles and let the place be quiet around him.

Questions (12 marks)

- 1 Why does Mr Adeyemi close the shop an hour early? Use two clues from the text. [2]
- 2 “his regulars had become occasional, then rare”. What does regulars mean here? [1]
- 3 “He knew what it said.” What does “it” refer to? [1]
- 4 “the rain drummed its impatient fingers on the awning”. Name the device and explain its effect. [2]
- 5 Why has the writer placed “three floors, free parking, bread at half his price” between dashes? [2]
- 6 How does the writer show that Mr Adeyemi finds it hard to leave the shop? Write one full PEE answer. [2]
- 7 Why does the writer include the photograph of his father from 1961? [1]
- 8 Why does the writer end with the short paragraph about the empty aisles? [1]

Self-check: where am I?

Mark your own work from the answers, then fill this in. Be honest: this decides what we drill next week.

Q	Skill it tests	My mark	My weakest skill this week
1	Inference (two clues)	/2	1. _____
2	Vocabulary in context	/1	
3	Reference words	/1	2. _____
4	Figurative language	/2	
5	Author’s craft: punctuation	/2	One thing I will do about it:
6	PEE: point, evidence, explain	/2	
7	Author’s craft: why include it	/1	_____
8	Author’s craft: ending	/1	

Total: _____ / 12